

[PROJECT / PRODUCT] / FOUR-SQUARE CONSTITUTIONAL LETTERHEAD	[PROJECT VERSION] Four-Square Template v1.2
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PROJECT CONSTITUTION / CONTRACT / LETTERHEAD

FOUR-SQUARE RELEASE LINEAGE

main1 = repository first commit / immutable root reference

SPEC spec-v1.2	[LANE-A] [lane-a]-v1.2	[LANE-B] [lane-b]-v1.2	MEMORY memory-v1.2
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SPEC and MEMORY are fixed. The two middle lanes are project-defined and **SHOULD** remain stable across versions.

CONSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE

MUST / MUST NOT binding law	SHALL / SHALL NOT constitutional alias	SHOULD / SHOULD NOT strong guidance	MAY permitted option	EXCEPTION / WAIVER explicit departure
MISSION [MISSION]	CORE PRINCIPLE [CORE PRINCIPLE]		BOUNDARY [BOUNDARY / OUT OF SCOPE]	

CONSTITUTIONAL HIERARCHY / FORMS

CONSTITUTION → ARTICLES / LAWS → CONTRACTS → POLICIES → GUARDRAILS → RECOMMENDED PRACTICES → CHECKLISTS

The form label does not determine force; the normative keyword does.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

ID	FORM	FORCE	CLAUSE
L1	LAW	MUST	Binding requirements MUST be explicit and observable.
L2	GUARDRAIL	MUST NOT	A binding requirement MUST NOT be silently weakened, bypassed or guessed away.
L3	POLICY	SHOULD	Material SHOULD deviations SHOULD have a recorded reason.
L4	CONTRACT	MUST	Missing evidence MUST result in NOT YET PROVEN , not assumed success.
L5	MEMORY	MUST NOT	MEMORY MUST NOT create new law unless promoted into SPEC.

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

CONFORMANT	CONFORMANT WITH EXCEPTION	NON-CONFORMANT	NOT YET PROVEN
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A **MUST** / **MUST NOT** deviation **MUST** be visible. An **EXCEPTION** / **WAIVER MUST** identify clause, scope, owner, rationale, evidence and review/expiry condition where applicable.

RELEASE LAW

Draft ≠ Tested ≠ Accepted ≠ Released. Claims **MUST** be scoped to evidence actually validated. A release **MUST NOT** hide unresolved binding violations. One version, four squares, all green.

Four-Square Template v1.2 SPEC + MEMORY fixed	MUST / SHOULD / MAY force is explicit	main1 = immutable root main = accepted integration
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PAGE 2 — GOVERNANCE / DEVELOPMENT / EXCEPTIONS

Use when project complexity requires more than the one-page constitutional identity.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

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DEVELOPMENT GOVERNANCE — RECOMMENDED CHECKLIST

- ☐ Material work **SHOULD** use a checklist or equivalent visible plan.
- ☐ Each binding clause **SHOULD** map to a verification item and observable evidence.
- ☐ Agents **MAY** perform Discover → Plan → Execute → Observe → Verify → Record with defined responsibilities.
- ☐ Agents **MUST NOT** reinterpret or waive constitutional law without explicit authority.
- ☐ Proven libraries, binaries, scripts, documents, services, datasets, models, plugins and utilities **SHOULD** be evaluated before new core work.

EXCEPTION / WAIVER PROTOCOL

CLAUSE	SCOPE	OWNER	RATIONALE	EVIDENCE	REVIEW / EXPIRY
[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

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